



Intel chips delayed

Expect the first 7nm Intel Chips to be available in 2022, with the 10nm desktop chips available from 2023. <https://digit.in/aug20-57>



iPhone 11 made in India

Apple has begun manufacturing the iPhone 11 locally in India; can consumers expect a price drop? <https://digit.in/aug20-58>

OnePlus TV U-Series 55-inch

A good value for money proposition

OnePlus has been a successful name in the smartphone space, giving the competition a run for its money. In 2019, the company decided to enter the TV market. OnePlus launched three TVs as a part of its 2020 TV lineup. We are reviewing the OnePlus 55-inch U TV. Let's find out how it fares.

Build and design

One look at the OnePlus U TV and you know it is premium. The bezels on three sides of the TV are virtually non-existent and only the bottom has a bezel. The TV is quite slim too. The back of the TV comes with a sleek carbon fibre finish.

The OnePlus U 55-inch 4K HDR TV has two feet. There is only one position for the feet – wide, they just about fit on our table and you should know that you will need a table almost as wide as the TV to fit it properly. The tabletop feet are heavy, fit in place with three screws and are extremely strong. They feel strong and hold the TV in place very well.

Last but not least, the connectivity options are on one side. We have three HDMI ports, two USB ports, ethernet, antenna, optical audio out and AV in. There is no 3.5mm port.

The OnePlus U TV's remote control is thick, has a rounded back, and has a nice grip. It is silver in colour and quite plasticky. It isn't as premium built as the TV but it is functional. The remote control runs on two AAA batteries and is not rechargeable.

TV UI and Mobile app

The OnePlus U runs on Android with OnePlus' own twist added to it. You have the option of stock Android TV and OnePlus' own Oxygen Play UI thrown into the mix. Oxygen Play is a decent UI but we prefer the fluidity,



Price
₹49,999



BUILD AND DESIGN.....82
FEATURES.....84
PERFORMANCE.....70
VALUE.....79

customisation and convenience of a stock Android TV.

OnePlus' Oxygen Play app is back and available on iOS as well this time around. The app is functional, acting as a second screen for you. You can control the volume of the OnePlus U TV using the phone's volume rocker, you can change the app on the TV from the comfort of the phone and you can cast content. Overall, the app is pretty functional.

Performance

Starting with the performance of the TV, it has a VA panel and support for 4K along with HDR 10, HDR 10+, HLG and Dolby Vision. The company did not confirm to us the maximum brightness of the panel in nits. It does not have dimming zones, rather uses "global dimming and dynamic contrast" to give you the black levels. One thing to note is that if you will consume content in a bright room, you should bump up the backlighting to full to get a good experience. Since the TV has a VA panel, viewing it from an angle makes the colours look off.

Considering the price of the TV, the performance in HDR content is good but the panel can get quite reflective in a brightly lit room.

We played a lot of FHD content from the TV. The scenes in Young Sheldon look bright, and the facial features of the characters are visible with details. Even Mad Max, which again, has a warm tone to it, looked good on the Standard preset and the colours look oversaturated in vivid. Even 1080p content off YouTube looked good.

We played several games on the Xbox One X to test the TV's gaming performance. The gaming performance of the TV is great for games in well-lit environments but in a room with a lot of natural light, games like The Last of Us 2 look too reflective.

The OnePlus U TV has 4 drivers with a total sound output of 30W. The volume on this TV can get loud and dialogues are clear. Switching from Standard to the Surround preset makes the audio sound more room-filling, but at the cost of clarity, in our opinion.

Bottomline

The OnePlus U 55-inch TV has a good build, ample connectivity options and a smooth UI. The picture quality from the panel is good, but it can get very reflective. It brings with it support for HDR 10 and Dolby Vision as well. It has the potential to give Nokia, LG, Panasonic and TCL TV a run for its money, at this price point.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 55-inch | PANEL TYPE: VA LED | PANEL RESOLUTION: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY ATMOS SUPPORT: Yes | HDMI PORTS: 3 | USB PORTS: 2 | BLUETOOTH: Yes | WI-FI: Yes | ETHERNET: Yes | SPEAKERS: 4 drivers with a total sound output of 30W | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 16GB

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